

Decory Edwards
Johns Hopkins University
Department of Economics

December 25, 2025

Hiring Committee
FW Cook
Los Angeles, CA

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Compensation Consultant position at FW Cook with a July 2026 start. I am currently a PhD candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University. My training combines quantitative analysis, structured financial reasoning, and clear written communication. I am motivated by problems that require careful benchmarking, disciplined modeling, and precise recommendations. FW Cook's focus on rigorous, client facing compensation analysis aligns closely with how I approach analytical work.

My research agenda is at the intersection of wealth inequality and macroeconomics. In my job market paper, I build and estimate a structural heterogeneous agent model with returns that differ across households. The core contribution is to show how heterogeneity in returns and income risk jointly shape the wealth distribution and consumption behavior. Relative to closely related work, my framework performs better at matching the lower and middle portions of the wealth distribution. This difference matters quantitatively. Models that focus primarily on returns heterogeneity can fit the top of the wealth distribution closely but tend to generate too much wealth among the bottom half of households. In my framework, income uncertainty generates a precautionary saving motive that produces genuinely low wealth households. This leads to a realistic distribution of marginal propensities to consume and aggregate consumption responses that align with empirical estimates.

A key feature of my research is the use of quantitative modeling and comparative analysis to evaluate incentives and outcomes. I work with large datasets, construct peer comparisons, and analyze performance metrics to support clear conclusions. I regularly prepare tables, figures, and written summaries that translate analysis into actionable recommendations. This work requires attention to detail, accuracy, and the ability to manage multiple tasks, skills that map directly to executive compensation benchmarking and incentive plan analysis.

I am particularly interested in FW Cook because of its specialization in compensation system design and its emphasis on rigorous, independent advice. The opportunity to contribute to client deliverables, collaborate closely with project teams, and develop expertise across financial, accounting, and governance considerations is especially appealing. I value environments that uphold high ethical standards and reward careful, service oriented work.

My economics training has provided a strong foundation in analytical reasoning, financial analysis, and professional communication. I am highly proficient in Excel and PowerPoint and comfortable building models, designing charts and tables, and drafting client ready reports. I work well both independently and as part of a team and take pride in producing accurate and reliable work under deadlines.

I am also enthusiastic about the prospect of living and working in Los Angeles and participating in a hybrid consulting environment. I see this role as an opportunity to apply my analytical training in a client focused setting while building a long term career in compensation consulting.

I would welcome the opportunity to contribute my skills and perspective to FW Cook. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards